

May 06, 2026

Ordering Provider: Dr. Aisha Washington, Neurology
NPI: 1122334455

Patient: Priya Shah | DOB: 07/22/1985 | Sex: F
Payer: United Healthcare | Plan: Choice Plus | Member ID: UHC9PS00531

REQUESTED PROCEDURE(S)
HCPCS J0585 [PRIMARY] - Injection, onabotulinumtoxinA, 1 unit

MEDICAL NECESSITY NARRATIVE

Priya S. meets full criteria for chronic migraine without aura (G43.701), documenting 18 headache days per month with 10 migraine-quality days each lasting greater than 4 hours. Propranolol (4-month beta-blocker trial) and topiramate (3-month antiepileptic trial) each satisfy the >=2-month threshold across two separate drug classes. The requested onabotulinumtoxinA (HCPCS J0585) at 155 units across 31 injection sites every 12 weeks aligns exactly with the UHC policy dosing limit (Policy CS2026D0017AP).

Submitted by: Dr. Aisha Washington, Neurology
NPI: 1122334455
Date: May 06, 2026

Provider Signature

AUTHORIZATION CRITERIA CHECKLIST

Patient: Priya S. | Payer: United Healthcare | Date: May 06, 2026

1. Diagnosis of chronic migraine defined by ALL of: ≥ 15 headache days/month, ≥ 8 migraine days/month, headaches last ≥ 4 hours/day

Rationale: 18 headache days/month, 10 migraine-quality days/month each lasting >4 hours documented -- all three UHC chronic migraine criteria satisfied.

Evidence: "18 headache days per month. 10 are migraine-quality. Each episode lasts greater than 4 hours without acute treatment."

2. History of failure (trial ≥ 2 months) from one agent in two classes: Antidepressant (amitriptyline, venlafaxine), Antiepileptic (divalproex, topiramate), Beta blocker (atenolol, propranolol, timolol, metoprolol)

Rationale: Propranolol (4-month, beta-blocker) and topiramate (3-month, antiepileptic) each meet the ≥ 2 -month threshold. Amitriptyline trialed only 6 weeks -- below the 2-month threshold.

Evidence: "Propranolol 40 mg BID: 4-month trial, discontinued for worsening BP. Topiramate 100 mg nightly: 3-month trial, discontinued for cognitive side effects. Amitriptyline 25 mg nightly: 6-week trial, discontinued for sedation."

3. Botox dose does not exceed 155 units IM divided over 31 injection sites across 7 head/neck muscles every 12 weeks

Rationale: 155 units across 31 injection sites every 12 weeks documented -- exact match to UHC policy dosing limit.

Evidence: "155 units IM divided across 31 injection sites across 7 head and neck muscles (corrugator, procerus, frontalis, temporalis, occipitalis, cervical paraspinal, trapezius) every 12 weeks."